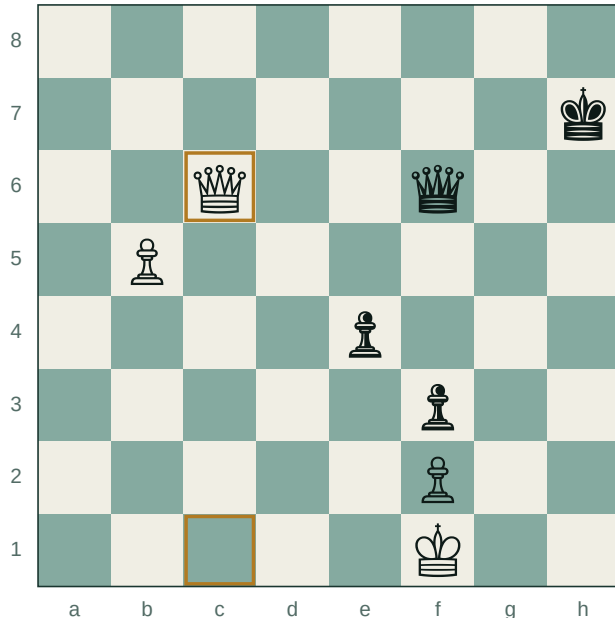


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 54

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 54.Qxc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

54...Qa1+ 55. Qc1 Qxc1#

54...Qa1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **55.Qc1**.

55...Qxc1# Mate: queen on c1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on c1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on f1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.